

HYUN SOO SUH

Department of Economics, Washington University in St. Louis

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EDUCATION

- University of Chicago** 2026 – 2027
- Visitor in Residence, **Center for the Economics of Human Development**
- Washington University in St. Louis** 2021 – 2027 (Expected)
- Ph.D. in Economics
 - M.A. in Economics 2023
- Boston University** 2019 – 2020
- M.A. in Economics *MA Prize of Academic Excellence*
- Korea University** 2015 – 2019
- B.A. in Economics & B.A. in French Language and Literature *Great Honor*
- Sciences Po** Fall 2017
- Exchange Student in Economics *Le Certificat en Sciences Sociales et Humanités*

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

- **Who Gains from Maternal Employment? Self-Employment, Childcare, and Child Development**
Abstract: Whether a mother's employment helps or harms her child depends on how well formal childcare substitutes for her time. I estimate a household life-cycle model of work arrangements, time, and child skill formation on UK panel data, and find that this substitutability differs sharply by education. Using the paid-versus-self-employment margin, I decompose a work arrangement into three attributes: flexibility, earnings level, and earnings volatility. Fathers' time responds little to a young child, so mothers are the sole margin of adjustment. A college-educated mother's time is her child's most productive input, which formal care substitutes for poorly, while for a non-college mother it substitutes well. Full-time employment therefore lowers a child's skills by 0.15–0.22 SD when the mother is college educated but raises them by 0.12–0.16 SD when she is not. Flexible hours without a pay penalty raise maternal employment by up to 4 percentage points but leave child skills essentially unchanged, because mothers take the added hours from leisure rather than time with the child. Childcare raises skills only when tagged by education. Pairing the two policies benefits both groups and raises the projected lifetime earnings of children of non-college mothers by up to 6 percent.

Publications

- **Beyond Time and Money: Parental Occupation and Early Childhood Development**
AEA Papers and Proceedings, 116: 605–610.

Working Papers

- **Female Micro-Entrepreneurship and Child Development** (with Andrew Foster and Moritz Poll) [NBER WP]
- **Mental Health and the Early Career Dynamics of Young Men** (with Cecilia Diaz-Campo, Barton Hamilton, and Martin Luccioni)

Work in Progress

- **Sorting on Gains: The STEM Gender Gap in Jamaica** (with George-Levi Gayle, Peter-John Gordon, Nadine McCloud-Rose, Rana Mohie Eldin, and Ismaël Mourifié)
- **Are Schools Equalizers or Amplifiers? School Value Added After a Randomized Anti-Poverty Program** (with Moritz Poll)

AWARDS & GRANTS

◦ Weiss Fund Research Grant	\$24,953; with Moritz Poll	2026 – 2028
◦ J-PAL Learning for All Initiative Grant	\$74,800; with Moritz Poll	2025 – 2026
◦ J-PAL Gender and Economic Agency Initiative Grant	\$49,696; with Moritz Poll	2025 – 2026
◦ INED Visiting Ph.D. Fellowship		Summer 2023
◦ Washington University in St. Louis Fellowship		2021 – Present
◦ Boston University Merit-Based Scholarship		2019 – 2020
◦ Boston University RA-Mentor Program Scholarship		Spring 2020
◦ Boston University Manuel Abdala Grant for Fieldwork		Spring 2020
◦ Boston University MA Prize of Academic Excellence		Spring 2020
◦ Korea University Great Honor		Fall 2019
◦ Korea University Semester High Honors		2015 – 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

◦ Washington University in St. Louis	RA to George-Lévi Gayle	Fall 2022 – Present
◦ Washington University in St. Louis	RA to Cecilia Diaz-Campo	Fall 2023
◦ World Bank	Short-Term Consultant	Mar – Jun 2021
◦ University of Pennsylvania	RA to Hans-Peter Kohler & Iliana Kohler	Mar – Aug 2021
◦ Boston University	RA to Yoonsook Ha	Oct 2019 – Jul 2021
◦ Boston University	RA to Mahesh Karra	Oct 2019 – Jun 2020
◦ Boston University	RA to Jordi Jaumandreu	Oct 2019 – May 2020
◦ INED	Internship	Jan – Mar 2019

TEACHING

Washington University in St. Louis

◦ Instructor: Introduction to Microeconomics	[Syllabus]	Summer 2025
◦ Instructor: Introduction to Stata	[Syllabus]	Spring 2024
◦ Assistant Instructor: Health Analytics (Spring 2026), Structural Microeconometrics - Graduate (Spring 2025), Microeconomics (Summer 2024), Industrial Organization (Fall 2022), Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2022)		

Korea University

◦ Peer Tutor: Microeconomics		Fall 2018
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CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS († scheduled · ‡ by co-author)

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- **2026** Allied Social Science Associations, West Indies Economic Conference, Midwest Economic Association[†], Centre for the Study of African Economies, North East Universities Gender Day, Population Association of America, Advances with Field Experiments[†], University of Pennsylvania[†], WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference[†]
 - **2025** Midwest Economic Association, WashU Applied Micro, Southeastern Health Economics Study Group Conference, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference, Annual Health Econometrics Workshop[‡], WashU Olin Brown Bag
 - **2024** WashU Applied Micro, WashU Graduate Research Symposium (3rd prize, Social Sciences), WashU Olin Brown Bag, American Society of Health Economists

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee Annals of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Development Economics, Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, Studies in Family Planning

Service Washington University in St. Louis

- President, Graduate Student Association 2024 – 2025
- Member, Graduate Student Association 2022 – 2026
- Co-organizer, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference (18th, 19th) 2023, 2024
- Co-organizer, WashU Job Market Jamboree (1st, 2nd) 2023, 2024
- Organizer, Applied Micro Research Group 2023 – 2024
- Co-organizer, Applied Metrics Study Group 2023 – 2024

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Socio-Economic Inequalities in Multidimensional Early Child Development: Evidence from France (with Lidia Panico and Anne Solaz)
Population, Conditionally Accepted.
- Understanding Relations between State-Level Variation in TANF Spending and Substantiated Child Maltreatment in the USA (with Yoonsook Ha, Judith C. Scott, Mary Elizabeth Collins)
Journal of Social Service Research, 48.4, 2022: 441–450.
- Embedding Financial Services in Frequented, Trusted Settings: Building on Families' Pre-existing Economic Mobility Efforts (with Savannah P. Alexander, Inhye Cellina Kim, Cyndie Hatcher, Yoonsook Ha, and Lucy E. Marcil)
Journal of Developmental & Behavioral Pediatrics, 43.7, 2022: e442–451.
- Climate Change and Productivity of Northeastern Dairy Farms (with Rigoberto A. Lopez, Christopher Laughton, and Donghoon Kim)
Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, 51.2, 2022: 203–221.

SKILLS

Programming Matlab, Julia, Stata, L^AT_EX, QGIS

Languages Korean (native), English (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor Barton H. Hamilton
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Professor George-Levi Gayle
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